



The client portal: two weeks of build

Everything added since the portal first ran. A working portal became a product — and then it learned to tell us when something has gone wrong.

125

CHANGES SHIPPED

14

INFO SHEETS LIVE

20

MARKETING
DOCUMENTS

5 min

AUTO-SYNC CYCLE

30

COUNCILS LINKED

LODGING A JOB

- ✓ **Instant lodgement** — jobs land on our board the second they're lodged
- ✓ **Address autocomplete** — real WA addresses picked from a list, no typos
- ✓ **Drag & drop** across every upload, with progress bars, at any size
- ✓ **Site photos** — phone shots auto-bundled into one tidy PDF
- ✓ **My documents library** — save engineering once, tick to attach on every job
- ✓ **Client's own reference number** — on the job, in email subjects, searchable
- ✓ Certificates of title / BA1 forms quietly filtered out
- ✓ Per-job-type checklists built into the form
- ✓ **Cancel a job** from the portal, with a reason — cancels on Monday, tells us

THE SITE PLAN TOOL

REBUILT THIS WEEK

- ✓ **Aerial photo of the site** dropped in behind the plan from the address
- ✓ **Real lot boundaries** from the WA cadastre — shape, dimensions, orientation
- ✓ Take hold of the boundary: drag any corner or edge, add one, take one out
- ✓ **Trace the lot** corner by corner over the photo, with squaring and snapping
- ✓ **Free draw** any shape — L-shapes and odd footprints — and name it as you close it
- ✓ Preset shapes, per-structure colour, 90° rotation, drag-to-resize
- ✓ Structures marked **existing** or **proposed**, readable in black and white
- ✓ Live **setback measurements** outline to outline; tap a figure to pin it and print it
- ✓ Clean single-page print to scale; drawing stays on screen while the options scroll

FOLLOWING A JOB

- ✓ Live five-stage **visual timeline** on every job — upright on a phone
- ✓ **Per-job pages**: status, documents sent, full conversation
- ✓ **Assigned surveyor** shown on every job
- ✓ Elapsed-day count that **stops while the job is with the client**
- ✓ Automatic emails: information requests, CDC Package ready
- ✓ Replies land straight on the job — attachments included
- ✓ **Live notifications** — a new message or a finished package appears without a refresh
- ✓ **General enquiry channel** — ask us anything that isn't about a job **TODAY**
- ✓ **Search** by our ref, their ref, address or description + CSV export





What they get, and how it feels

DOWNLOADING & SELF-SERVICE

- ✓ One-click **CDC Package**; download receipts posted to our board
- ✓ Three-month availability with visible countdown, then automatic purge
- ✓ **Engineering checker** — full span/member solver, per-client access
- ✓ 14 photo-covered **guidance notes** — all rebuilt to one house template
- ✓ Every drawing and photo in the notes exported as a set
- ✓ **Resources hub**: council forms, bushfire-map check, 30 councils A–Z, each linked straight to that council's lodge-a-building-application page

DESIGN & FEEL

- ✓ Photo-hero design across every page, matched dusk photography
- ✓ Hand-drawn icon set for all eleven job types, and on every My Jobs row
- ✓ **Desktop-first**: full table on a desktop, cards on a phone
- ✓ **Collapsible sidebar** — fold the menu to a rail when the page needs the room
- ✓ My Jobs opens on the jobs still running, not the finished ones
- ✓ Title Case across every heading, title and label
- ✓ Motion & touch feedback throughout; install-to-home-screen
- ✓ Every message rewritten warm and human; dead ends offer a phone number

OPERATIONS (THE OFFICE VIEW)

- ✓ **Five-minute auto-sync** with a health banner — one glance covers the whole system
- ✓ **Ten-minute issue hold** — an undo window before any client is told
- ✓ OneDrive guard — never ships a half-synced folder; Word templates auto-excluded
- ✓ Unmatched-client workbench; issued-but-no-files and email-failure warnings
- ✓ **Enquiries desk** — questions with no job attached, unanswered first **TODAY**
- ✓ Admin toggles: hide any section live; supersede info sheets without a deploy
- ✓ Council-forms manager; engineering-set manager with per-client access
- ✓ Named client logins; append-only **audit log**; turnaround reports
- ✓ **SharePoint diagnostic** — one page that says exactly why a package didn't arrive
- ✓ Weekly client digest (optional switch)



Nothing goes quiet, and what's next

THE BOARD KNOWS WHERE EVERY JOB IS

TODAY

- ✓ The **Send?** column is now the job's journey to the client, not a yes/no flag
- ✓ **SENT** — set by hand when the office issues it and puts the files out
- ✓ **READY** — written by the portal once it HAS the files and the client has been emailed
- ✓ **DOWNLOADED** — written by the portal when the client actually takes it
- ✓ **Job Sent** date stamped with the day the client could first get it
- ✓ Forward only: never rewrites a rung reached, never drags a card back, never invents a label

NOTHING GOES QUIET

TODAY

- ✓ **Evening report**, 5pm weekdays — everything that should have reached a client and didn't
- ✓ A lodgement that never made the board · a job issued whose files never arrived
- ✓ A client never told their package was ready · a package ready for days and never opened
- ✓ Board writes Monday wouldn't take · enquiries waiting on an answer
- ✓ Reads "the sync isn't running" first — everything else is only as fresh as the last run
- ✓ A clean day still sends, two lines; preview or send it from /admin any time

SECURITY & RESILIENCE

- ✓ All documents in **private Australian storage**; every download ownership-checked
- ✓ Hardened sign-in: hashed passwords, one-time setup codes, attempt throttling
- ✓ Silent-failure class eliminated — every write verified, every failure visible
- ✓ **One bad job can no longer stop the sync** for everybody else
- ✓ Data minimisation: declined-lodgement files deleted; 3-month purge honoured
- ✓ WA public holidays (2026–27, verified) in the turnaround maths
- ✓ Privacy notice drafted; collection wording ready for sign-off

SPECCED AND QUEUED (DESIGNS AGREED, IN THE REGISTER)

- ✓ **AI document checker** — every Class 10 lodgement checked against our requirements; staff-only findings + a drafted FIR
- ✓ **Guidance assistant** — answers from our own published notes, hands off to messages
- ✓ Site plan tool v3 — generated elevations from the plan
- ✓ One-off public lodgement — no-login homeowner jobs via magic links
- ✓ Teams-style notification of client messages into a CFBA channel
- ✓ SLIP subscription licence so the cadastre can be used commercially

The shape of the fortnight: the portal lodges faster than email, answers "where's my job?" before the phone rings, and drafts the client's site plan over a real aerial and a real lot boundary. This week it learned the two things that matter most in an office: the board now shows where every job has got to on its way out the door, and if a job goes quiet, we hear the same day.